

WAITING FOR THE FESTIVAL

INDIA'S SMARTPHONE shipments declined 1 per cent YoY in Jan-March 2022 to cross 38 million units, thanks to the ongoing component shortage and falling demand during the third wave of Covid-19. The outlook for Q2, too, looks bleak, with the challenges persisting, but Tarun Pathak, Research Director at Counterpoint Research, says some demand might be pushed to the festive season.

—NIDHI SINGAL



₹1.71

**LAKH CRORE
RECORD PAY-
MENT MADE
BY THE UT-
TAR PRADESH
GOVERN-
MENT TO
4.57 MILLION
SUGARCANE
FARMERS
FROM 2017 TO
APRIL 2022**

CLASH OF THE TITANS

A duopoly is emerging in the country's hypercompetitive skies, and it's evident in Air India's proposal to acquire the balance 16.33 per cent equity in low-cost carrier AirAsia India. Tatas' four airlines—Air India, Air India Express, Vistara and AirAsia India—have a market share of 24.2 per cent, while rival IndiGo leads with 54.8 per cent. With the Competition Commission of India expected to clear the proposal, the Tatas would then focus on integrating Air India Express and Vistara to eventually challenge IndiGo's dominance. Brace for action.

—MANISH PANT



PHOTO BY MANDAR DEODHAR

IPO INSURED

The mega public issue of LIC was comfortably oversubscribed—2.95 times, to be precise—but the impact of the volatile markets was clearly visible. The insurance giant had to significantly reduce the IPO size from the earlier estimated ₹60,000 crore to ₹21,000 crore. Interestingly, the portion reserved for policyholders was subscribed over six times while that for employees was subscribed 4.4 times. The segments for institutional and high net worth individuals were subscribed 2.83 times and 2.91 times, respectively.

—ASHISH RUKHAIYAR



TAXMAN ON YOUR SCREEN

GST collection for April 2022 reached a record ₹1.68 lakh crore, significantly surpassing the March figure of ₹1.43 lakh crore. The sharp growth is based on all major states reporting 9-25 per cent increases, with a total of 10.6 million GST returns filed, and 77 million e-way bills generated. Strong economic recovery? Well, yes, but the taxman's gotten smarter, too, using stricter norms on input tax credit, and technologies such as artificial intelligence and analytics to great effect.

—MANISH PANT

Khadi Rocks

AMID THE CONTINUOUS blitzkrieg by offshore fashion and apparel brands, indigenous Khadi and Village Industries Commission (KVIC) has emerged as the champion of Indian fashion. KVIC raked in ₹1.15 lakh crore in sales in FY2021-22 to become the first consumer goods company in India to clock a yearly revenue of ₹1 lakh crore or more—beating other consumer companies like Maruti Suzuki (₹88,295 crore), Samsung (₹75,886 crore in FY21) and Adani Wilmar (₹54,214 crore). KVIC, which posted 20.6 per cent YoY growth last fiscal, has also made inroads into overseas markets such as Germany, Prime Minister Narendra Modi said at a recent event.

—ARNAB DUTTA



PHOTO BY M ZHAZO